

BARON ZEMO

Like father, like son



After the accident that bonded his mask to his face, the original Baron Zemo became obsessed with destroying Captain America

Helmut Zemo is the son of Baron Heinrich Zemo, a Nazi scientist during World War II who designed super-weapons. Heinrich Zemo was working on a glue, "Adhesive X," that could never be dissolved, hoping it could be used to immobilize Allied troops. CAPTAIN AMERICA broke into his lab and, in the fight, Cap's shield shattered the vat containing the adhesive and Zemo's mask was glued to his head.

MASTER OF EVIL

Zemo later went to London to steal an experimental drone plane. Captain America and his teenage partner BUCKY BARNES attempted to stop him, but Bucky was killed and Captain America was flung into the ocean, where he fell into a state of suspended animation. When the Nazis lost the war, Zemo fled to the jungles of South America where he conquered a small kingdom.

Decades later, he came out of hiding after learning that Captain America had been revived by the Avengers. Zemo formed the first MASTERS OF EVIL and later transformed Simon Williams into WONDER MAN, but failed in all his attempts to destroy the Avengers. He was accidentally crushed by a landslide during a battle with Captain America.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Avengers #16** During a battle with Captain America, the original Baron Zemo is killed.
- **Captain America #357-362** "The Bloodstone Hunt"—Helmut Zemo tries to resurrect his father.
- **The Avengers: Under Siege, tpb** Helmut's new Masters of Evil invade the Avengers' Mansion and take Edwin Jarvis hostage.
- **Thunderbolts: Justice Like Lightning, tpb** Helmut Zemo repositions the Masters of Evil into seeming heroes.

FROM VILLAIN TO HERO

The Baron's son, Helmut, calling himself Phoenix, attempted to drown Cap in a boiling vat of Adhesive X. The liquid splashed Helmut, scarring his face and giving it the appearance of melted wax. Zemo later organized a new Masters of Evil.

When the Avengers temporarily disappeared from this reality, Zemo gathered his Masters of Evil. They became the THUNDERBOLTS, Super Villains masquerading as heroes. Helmut assumed the identity of Citizen V, a British costumed hero murdered by the original Baron Zemo. Like most of the Thunderbolts team, Zemo grew into the role of being a real hero. After keeping the Grandmaster



MASTERS OF EVIL

- 1 Absorbing Man 2 Baron Zemo
3 Screaming Mimi 4 Mr. Hyde 5 Moonstone
6 The Fixer 7 Power Man

from the Wellspring of Power, he took control of it himself, claiming that he would use it to better the world. The other Thunderbolts, who no longer trusted him, knocked him into a time vortex instead. After making his way back from the past, Zemo has dedicated himself to making the world a better place.

TD, MF

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Helmut Zemo

OCCUPATION

Criminal entrepreneur

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 11 in

WEIGHT 183 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Blond

FIRST APPEARANCE

Captain America #168

(June 1971)

Master strategist, extensive training in hand-to-hand combat, and excellent marksman; lacks his father's scientific genius.



Zemo's hatred of Captain America ultimately led to the rock fall that killed him.



Helmut Zemo claims that he wants to atone for his past misdeeds.

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POWERS